

Luxury Dossier

Martha's Vineyard

Everything to know about luxury real estate in the iconic New England destination

By KATE HINSCHKE



Martha's Vineyard, seven miles off the coast of Massachusetts in the Atlantic Ocean, originated as an outpost for the whaling industry and now attracts rich and powerful seasonal residents, including first families stretching from the Kennedys to the Obamas. After many years of renting, Barack and Michelle Obama dropped \$11.8 million on a 29-acre, waterfront estate fronting the Edgartown Great Pond in 2019.

Like many luxury destinations, the island's cedar-shingled homes surged in pricing as deal activity picked up in recent years. Corcoran's Maggie Gold Seelig was one of the brokers last year involved with the \$37 million sale of Norman Foster's 30-acre Chilmark estate to Les Wexner — an island record.

Seelig, who also does deals in the Hamptons, said that more people are turning to the Vineyard for its laid-back attitude — an increasingly rare quality in second home markets.

"Even though it attracts attention from people all over the world, the pace is a little slower. There's not a hustle and bustle," she said.

Seelig said island buyers come from Hollywood, Wall Street and Silicon Valley; some are artists and writers seeking generational family homes.

The Vineyard's high season for tourism is between Memorial Day and Labor Day, and that's also generally its busy season for home sales. On an island of many long dirt roads, muddy winters can complicate getting to showings in the off-season. Development is tightly controlled and inventory limited, factors that contribute to the island's ever-higher prices. Seelig anticipates a continued upward trend for sales and pricing.

"We're setting the standard now for what the Vineyard is and should be," she said. **TMD**

Median sale price

\$1.6M

SOURCE: SOTHEBY'S INTERNATIONAL REALTY AS OF APRIL 2026



Average days on market

136

Down 9 percent YOY

SOURCE: SOTHEBY'S INTERNATIONAL REALTY AS OF APRIL 2026



Notable new developments (resi + commercial)

IN MAY, THE MARTHA'S VINEYARD COMMISSION APPROVED THE ISLAND'S **LARGEST HOUSING PROJECT EVER**, THE 116-UNIT **GREEN VILLA**. DEVELOPER WILLIAM CUMMING, THE HEAD OF ATWOOD COMPANY, USED MASSACHUSETTS' 40B PROGRAM, WHICH ALLOWS FOR MORE DENSE DEVELOPMENT IF A PORTION OF A PROJECT IS SLATED FOR AFFORDABLE HOUSING. GREEN VILLA, WHICH WILL INCLUDE A MIX OF DUPLEXES AND TRIPLEXES, WILL HAVE **12 UNITS SET ASIDE FOR AFFORDABLE BUYERS AND 30 UNITS FOR ISLAND BUSINESSES TO PURCHASE AND OFFER TO THEIR EMPLOYEES**.



Most expensive listing

\$37M



41 COBBS HILL ROAD, CHILMARK

BUYER: LES WEXNER

LISTING AGENTS:

MAGGIE GOLD SEELIG, MGS GROUP AND BRIAN DOUGHERTY, CORCORAN PROPERTY ADVISORS

BUYER'S AGENT:

BRIAN DOUGHERTY, CORCORAN PROPERTY ADVISORS

BILLIONAIRE **LES WEXNER** SPENT A RECORD **\$37 MILLION** IN SUMMER 2025 ON THE **30-ACRE WATERFRONT COMPOUND** KNOWN AS BLUE HERON FARM, MADE FAMOUS DURING **THE OBAMA ADMINISTRATION AS THE FIRST FAMILY'S SUMMER RENTAL**. THE SELLER WAS THE PRITZKER PRIZE-WINNING **ARCHITECT NORMAN FOSTER**, WHO BOUGHT THE PROPERTY FOR \$22.4 MILLION IN 2011 AND EMBARKED ON AN EXTENSIVE RENOVATION. IT INCLUDES A 150-YEAR-OLD BARN, A MAIN HOUSE, A GUEST HOUSE, A BOAT HOUSE, A TENNIS COURT, RIDING PADDOCKS AND A PRIVATE BEACH.

The main markets



- A. Edgartown
- B. Oak Bluffs
- C. Tisbury (A.K.A. VINEYARD HAVEN)
- D. West Tisbury
- E. Chilmark
- F. Aquinnah



Top five brokers with highest deal volume (REALTRENDS)



1. **Alyssa Halisky**
WALLACE & CO. SOTHEBY'S INTERNATIONAL REALTY
\$37.3M

2. **Thomas Wallace**
WALLACE & CO. SOTHEBY'S INTERNATIONAL REALTY
\$23M

3. **Mark Jenkins**
WALLACE & CO. SOTHEBY'S INTERNATIONAL REALTY
\$21.2M

4. **Cassie Courtney**
WALLACE & CO. SOTHEBY'S INTERNATIONAL REALTY
\$12.5M

5. **Bonnie Pierce**
WALLACE & CO. SOTHEBY'S INTERNATIONAL REALTY
\$12.5M

"We are fundamentally changing the character of the island. I don't think I want to see the island change this way, just to solve the housing crisis."

BEN ROBINSON, MARTHA'S VINEYARD COMMISSIONER ON HIS OPPOSITION TO THE GREEN VILLA PROJECT

"The lack of housing for our community is a social disaster."

LINDA SIBLEY, MARTHA'S VINEYARD COMMISSIONER

"It's a collective of some of the most intelligent and influential people. There's a vibrancy to the island that you don't typically see in secondary home markets."

MAGGIE GOLD SEELIG, MGS GROUP



Names to know



Jason Brown

BROWN IS THE **CO-FOUNDER AND CEO OF BLUE FLAG CAPITAL**, A PRIVATE EQUITY FIRM FOCUSED ON BOUTIQUE HOSPITALITY INVESTMENTS IN SUCH RESORT DESTINATIONS AS MARTHA'S VINEYARD AND NANTUCKET. IN 2020, BLUE FLAG ACQUIRED AN ASSEMBLAGE IN DOWNTOWN EDGARTOWN INCLUDING **THE HISTORIC KELLEY HOUSE FOR \$19.6 MILLION**. THE FIRM REDEVELOPED THE PROPERTY INTO THE SECOND NEW ENGLAND OUTPOST OF ITS FARAWAY HOTEL BRAND, NOW ONE OF THE MOST EXPENSIVE HOTELS ON THE ISLAND.



Dan Pucillo

PUCILLO IS THE **CEO OF THE BLACK DOG TAVERN, THE FAMED VINEYARD HAVEN WATERFRONT RESTAURANT**, WHICH SPAWNED A RETAIL EMPIRE THAT NOW STRETCHES FROM MAINE TO GEORGIA. BEST KNOWN FOR ITS MERCH FEATURING A BLACK DOG WITH A RED COLLAR, THE TAVERN IS **OPENING ANOTHER RESTAURANT IN OAK BLUFFS THIS SUMMER** DUBBED COASTWISE PUB.



David Malm

MALM IS A **MANAGING PARTNER OF WEBSTER EQUITY PARTNERS**, A HEALTHCARE PRIVATE EQUITY FIRM. HE'S ALSO A PROLIFIC INVESTOR IN MARTHA'S VINEYARD'S LUXURY REAL ESTATE MARKET, WITH A NEARLY **\$100 MILLION PORTFOLIO OF HOMES** ON THE ISLAND AND NEIGHBORING NANTUCKET. HIS HOLDINGS INCLUDE CHIP CHOP, THE LONGTIME VINEYARD HAVEN ESTATE OF DIANE SAWYER, WHICH HE BOUGHT FOR \$23.9 MILLION IN 2023.



Biggest upcoming fight
Affordable development

LIKE MANY COMMUNITIES AROUND THE COUNTRY, MARTHA'S VINEYARD IS FACING A **PROTRACTED AFFORDABILITY CRISIS**. BUILDING ENOUGH TO ADDRESS THE SHORTAGE OF HOMES HAS PROVEN DIFFICULT IN A COMMUNITY THAT PRIDES ITSELF ON THE PRESERVATION OF ITS SMALL SCALE AND HISTORIC CHARACTER. IN APRIL, THE STATE'S HOUSING APPEALS COMMITTEE STRIPPED THE MARTHA'S VINEYARD COMMISSION OF ITS AUTHORITY OVER AFFORDABLE DEVELOPMENT APPLICATIONS, THE VINEYARD GAZETTE REPORTED. **PROJECTS NOW ONLY NEED APPROVAL BY TOWN ZONING BOARDS**. IT WON'T BE THE LAST WORD ON THE RED TAPE ISSUE, WITH MULTIPLE LAWSUITS IN MOTION CONCERNING PERMITTING JURISDICTION ON THE ISLAND.